resources the City has in ensuring our neighborhoods are healthy and thriving. It provides numerous immeasurable benefits to everyone living in the five boroughs, including improving human health and well-being, and I am very proud of the work our parkies do every day to grow and protect our city's trees.

Yet the importance of our urban canopy can be often overlooked and undervalued, even though our city's trees are essential living infrastructure, just as vital for New Yorkers as roads, subways, and telecommunication lines. New York City has nearly 43,000 acres of tree canopy, a full 23.4 percent of the city's land area, which is best defined as the cover or shade provided by our city trees. This robust urban forest provides an incredible array of environmental, social, and economic benefits, such as resourcing stormwater runoff, shading buildings, and conserving energy by reducing heating and cooling costs, protecting city's pavement from rain and sun, noise mitigation, increasing property values, and of course, cleaning and cooling the air, benefiting our overall health and well-being. Though a lot of the public's attention is focused on the value of